

came up with the idea of a home video game in 1951. And in the late 1960s, while he was working for Sanders Associates, he created a few designs for video game consoles. One of the designs earned the nickname of Brown Box. Having different game modes, it was demonstrated to multiple TV manufacturers. That's how Sanders Associates managed to land an agreement with Magnavox soon.

The Magnavox Odyssey was the first home game console that could be connected to a television set. Though the idea for cartridges were sketched up by Baer, the carts made by Magnavox served as just switches and enabled the players to choose from among the built-in games.

The Odyssey sold around 1,00,000 units – which wasn't bad but not great either.



Consoles - a great idea whose time had come!

But Atari soon came out with the arcade game Pong, the popularity of which made the public take note of the emerging gaming industry. In fact, the popularity of Pong was such that by 1975, Magnavox had to cancel the Odyssey and release a scaled-down version which played just Pong and hockey. And a subsequent version had a third game built-in: Smash.

And once the company, General Instrument released their inexpensive microchips, many small to mid-sized developers began to release consoles which looked different on the outside but all of which played the same set of games – which was mostly what came with the console. In fact, they were usually referred to with the blanket term of 'video games' since there was very little to differentiate individual consoles.

Home consoles

The evolution of home consoles could be traced back to the release of the Fairchild Video Entertainment System (VES) by the company, Fairchild,